4. Care of the Skin

- The baby must be cleaned off blood, mucous and meconium by gently wiping before he or she is presented to the mother.
- During hospital stay 'no bath' reduces the incidence of neonatal infections. No vigorous attempt should be made to remove the vernix caseosa.

5. Breast Feeding

- The baby should be put to the mother's breast within half an hour of birth or as soon as possible.
- No prelactal feeds to be given and colostrums feedings must be offered.
- Educate the mother about breast feeding techniques.
- Initially the feeding should be given in short interval of 1-2 hours and then every 2-3 hours. Most babies regularize their feeding pattern by the end of first week.

6. Baby Bath

- During hospital "No bath"
- Baby bath should be given with warm water in warm room
- Baby should be dried immediately from head to toe and wrapped in a dry warm towel.
- Use of olive oil or coconut oil can be allowed after 3-4 weeks of age.
- Exposure to sunlight is an important source of vitamin D and warmth.

7. Clothing

- The baby should be dressed with loose soft and cotton clothes.
- The clothes should not be too tight around the neck or abdomen.
- Clothes should be cleaned with light detergent and washed properly and sun dried.

8. General Care

- Baby should be handled with gentle approach after proper hand washing.
- No infected person should handle.
- Baby should be allowed to sleep in supine position.

9. Weight Recording

- Average daily weight gain in healthy, new born baby increases about 30g/day in the first month of life.
- It is about 20g/ day in second month and 10g/day afterwards during the first year of life.
- Most infants double their birth weight by 4-5 months.

10. Immunization

- All neonates should be immunized with BCG, 'O' dose OPV and 'hepatitis B' vaccine at birth.
- Mother should be informed about the recommended National Immunization Scheme.

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